



“First Europe, and then the globe, will be linked by flight, and nations so knit together that they will grow to be next-door neighbors... What railways have done for nations, airways will do for the world.”

CLAUDE GRAHAME-WHITE, 1914

COMMERCIAL BREAKTHROUGH

The Douglas DC-2 was introduced in 1934. An instant hit, it established 19 American speed and distance records in its first six months. For the first time, the American business traveler could fly from coast to coast without losing a day.



PASSENGERS NOW BOARDING

BETWEEN THE WARS, PASSENGER AIR TRAVEL RAPIDLY DEVELOPED FROM A PRIMITIVE AND HAZARDOUS ADVENTURE INTO A REFINED, TIME-SAVING SERVICE

THE FIRST sustained passenger airplane services were established in Europe in the immediate aftermath of World War I. They required a sturdy breed of customer. When the first daily international scheduled air service, between Hounslow, London, and Le Bourget, Paris, began in August 1919, the passengers traveled in open cockpits and wore protective clothing against the cold. The aircraft did not operate in bad weather and frequently failed to complete the three-hour journey nonstop, making forced landings in farmers' fields for repairs or refueling. For this dubious service passengers paid £42 return (about \$200) – equivalent to six months' pay for an average British worker.

Conditions on European passenger lines soon became less spartan, yet even in enclosed cabins passengers were subjected to deafening noise, sickening turbulence, bone-shaking vibration, and either stifling heat or freezing cold. Although forced landings soon became less common, cancellation of flights due to bad weather did not. The speed advantage aircraft enjoyed over the frequent and punctual trains that linked European cities was, to a large extent, undermined by the time it took to travel to and from aerodromes. What air transportation mostly had to offer the traveler was novelty and excitement, a new view of the Earth, and the sense of adventure and superiority that came from experiencing the



BUSINESS MOGUL

In 1916 William Boeing founded Pacific Aero Products. The next year, the company was renamed the Boeing Airplane Company, and between the wars it produced fighter planes for the US army and navy, as well as commercial passenger airliners. Boeing retired in 1934.

